

Why are women overlooked for leadership? It's time for a change!

Deep-rooted biases and **outdated stereotypes** frequently **overshadow** women's capabilities, despite evidence that women leaders **enhance** company performance and culture

In India, women are frequently overlooked for management and senior leadership roles despite their proven capabilities in both personal and professional **settings**. It's a complex issue **often attributed** to stereotypes, **unconscious** biases, and a society that still **grapples with entrenched** gender roles. Yet, if we pause and consider the day-to-day roles women play, particularly in an Indian household, it becomes **evident** that they **possess** an **array** of skills crucial to any organisation's success.

Imagine a typical day for a woman managing her household. She **coordinates** with household help, ensures that her family's needs are **met**, **oversees** children's schedules, and often also supports extended family members. Each of these tasks requires quick thinking, negotiation skills, **empathy**, and time management. **Such daily acts** of coordination and problem-solving **are, at their core**, management skills.

The inquiry **at hand** is, why do we fail to **acknowledge** these abilities when they are **showcased** in a professional setting?

Do these skills lose their validity simply because they originate from home-based experience? Many argue that women's ability to **blend** emotional intelligence with logical decision-making makes them especially **adept at** leadership roles.

Their approach is often **holistic**—they not only focus on completing tasks but also on **nurturing** relationships, **fostering** team **morale**, and ensuring that the process is as smooth as the outcome. Research indicates that **companies** with **gender-diverse** leadership teams **tend to** achieve better financial performance and **foster** a more satisfied workforce, contributing to a healthier company culture. Women bring different **perspectives** and problem-solving approaches, which **complement** male colleagues' styles. When women are given a seat at the table, companies gain a more **nuanced** understanding of their markets and customers.

And yet, despite clear advantages, women remain vastly underrepresented in senior roles. The reasons are rooted in a long history of gender bias. Women are often **pigeonholed** as too "emotional" or too "soft" for the challenges of executive positions, while men are assumed to be inherently more **decisive** and **resilient**. Yet, **resilience** is something that women **exemplify** every day—balancing multiple roles in a society that demands more of them both at home and at work.

Change is **on the horizon**, with many organisations now actively working to **bridge the gender gap** in leadership. However, it requires a deeper cultural shift to truly unlock the leadership potential of women. Organisations need to **embrace** mentorship programs, implement unbiased hiring practices,

and encourage flexible work policies that allow women to balance personal and professional responsibilities.

Moreover, celebrating women's leadership styles rather than forcing them to fit into traditionally **masculine** roles can create more authentic, powerful leaders. The argument is simple: women already **demonstrate** essential leadership skills every day, whether in boardrooms or in households. It's time to recognise their contributions and give them the opportunities they deserve.

For any organisation that values growth, empathy, and resilience, overlooking women isn't just unfair—it's a missed opportunity. Let's **champion** a future where leadership **is** based on talent and vision, not on outdated biases. Women are ready for the challenge, and it's time we give them the **space** to lead.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Embrace** (verb) – Accept, welcome, adopt, include, incorporate अपनाना

Vocabulary

1. **Overlook** (verb) – Ignore, neglect, disregard, pass over, fail to notice
नज़रअंदाज़ करना
2. **Deep-rooted** (adjective) – Entrenched, ingrained, established, firmly fixed, profound गहराई से जड़ा हुआ
3. **Biases** (noun) – Prejudices, partiality, favoritism, discrimination, predispositions पक्षपात
4. **Outdated** (adjective) – Old-fashioned, obsolete, antiquated, archaic, outmoded पुराना
5. **Stereotype** (noun) – Generalization, cliché, fixed idea, preconceived notion, conventional image रूढ़िवादी धारणा
6. **Overshadow** (verb) – Eclipse, outshine, dominate, surpass, dwarf महत्व कम करना
7. **Enhance** (verb) – Improve, augment, boost, amplify, strengthen बढ़ाना
8. **Setting** (noun) – Environment, context, surroundings, background, milieu परिवेश
9. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, habitually अक्सर
10. **Attributed** (to) (adjective) – Ascribed, credited, assigned, linked, associated संबंधित
11. **Unconscious** (adjective) – Subconscious, involuntary, automatic, unintentional, unaware अचेतन
12. **Grapple with** (phrasal verb) – Struggle with, wrestle with, contend with, deal with, confront से जूझना
13. **Entrenched** (adjective) – Established, ingrained, deep-seated, rooted, fixed स्थापित
14. **Evident** (adjective) – Obvious, clear, apparent, manifest, noticeable स्पष्ट
15. **Possess** (verb) – Have, own, hold, contain, acquire रखना
16. **Array** (noun) – Range, variety, collection, assortment, series विविधता
17. **Coordinate** (verb) – Organize, arrange, manage, harmonize, synchronize समन्वय करना
18. **Meet** (verb) – Fulfill, satisfy, comply with, achieve, accomplish पूरा करना
19. **Oversees** (verb) – Supervises, manages, directs, monitors, controls देखरेख करना
20. **Empathy** (noun) – Understanding, compassion, sympathy, sensitivity, fellow feeling सहानुभूति

21. **At one's core** (phrase) – Fundamentally, essentially, basically, at heart, inherently
मूल रूप से
22. **At hand** (phrase) – readily accessible when needed. उपलब्ध
23. **Acknowledge** (verb) – Recognize, admit, accept, concede, appreciate स्वीकार करना
24. **Showcase** (verb) – Display, exhibit, present, demonstrate, highlight प्रदर्शित करना
25. **Blend** (verb) – Combine, mix, merge, integrate, fuse मिलाना
26. **Adept** (at) (adjective) – Skilled, proficient, expert, capable, talented निपुण
27. **Holistic** (adjective) – Comprehensive, integrated, all-inclusive, complete, total समग्र
28. **Nurture** (verb) – Foster, cultivate, develop, support, encourage पोषण करना
29. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, cultivate, support प्रोत्साहित करना
30. **Morale** (noun) – Confidence, spirit, enthusiasm, optimism, motivation हौसला
31. **Gender-diverse** (adjective) – Gender-inclusive, mixed-gender, gender-balanced, varied in gender लिंग विविध
32. **Tend** (to) (verb) – Be inclined to, be likely to, have a tendency to, usually, generally प्रवृत्त होना
33. **Perspective** (noun) – Viewpoint, outlook, stance, approach, standpoint दृष्टिकोण
34. **Complement** (verb) – Enhance, complete, supplement, add to, go well with पूरक होना
35. **Nuanced** (adjective) – Subtle, refined, delicate, detailed, sophisticated सूक्ष्म
36. **Pigeonhole** (verb) – Stereotype, categorize, label, classify, typecast रूढ़िबद्ध करना
37. **Decisive** (adjective) – Determined, resolute, firm, conclusive, definitive निर्णायक
38. **Resilient** (adjective) – Strong, adaptable, flexible, hardy, tough मज़बूत
39. **Exemplify** (verb) – Illustrate, demonstrate, represent, embody, typify उदाहरण देना
40. **On the horizon** (phrase) – Imminent, forthcoming, approaching, upcoming, in the near future निकट भविष्य में
41. **Bridge the gap** (phrase) – Close the difference, reduce the disparity, connect, reconcile, bring together अंतर को कम करना
42. **Moreover** (adverb) – Furthermore, besides, in addition, also, additionally इसके अलावा

43. **Masculine** (adjective) – Male, manly, virile, macho, masculine-associated पुरुषत्व संबंधी

45. **Space** (noun) – Opportunity, room, scope, capacity, area गुंजाइश

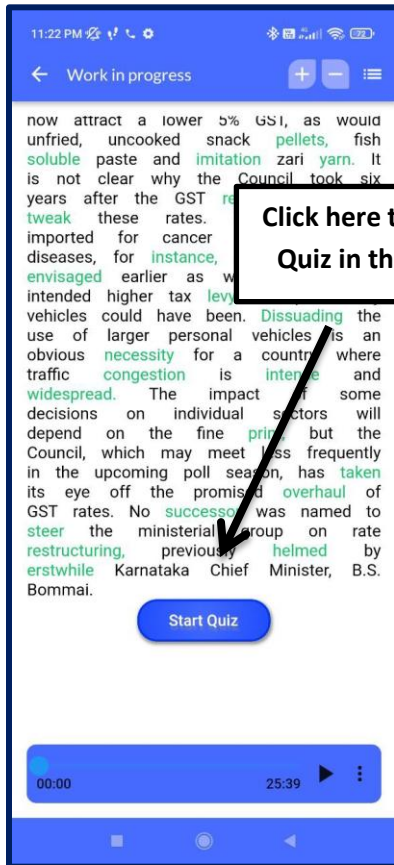
44. **Demonstrate** (verb) – Show, display, exhibit, prove, manifest दिखाना

@mocks_wallah

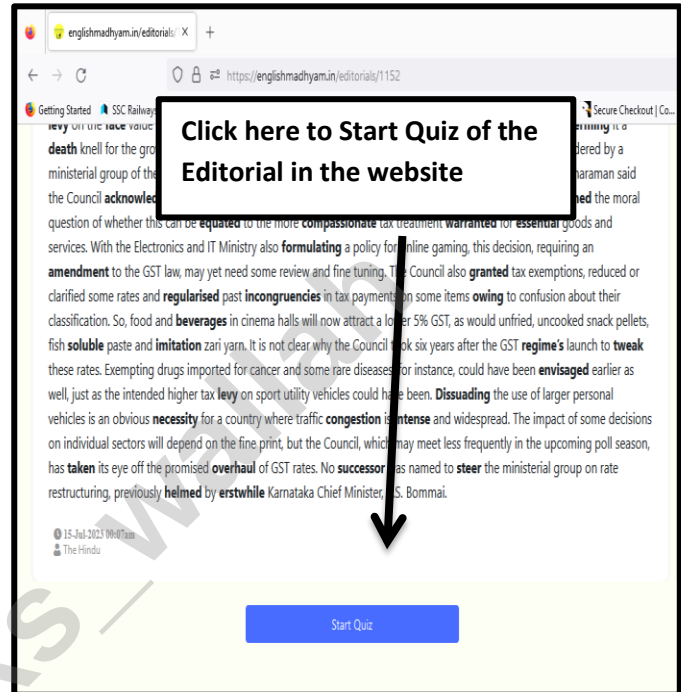
Summary of the Editorial

1. Women in India are frequently overlooked for leadership roles despite showcasing strong capabilities both at home and professionally.
2. Stereotypes and unconscious biases still dominate society, making it difficult for women to break through into senior leadership.
3. Women handle complex household responsibilities that require critical management skills such as negotiation, empathy, and time management.
4. These skills are undervalued when transferred to professional settings, despite being crucial for organisational success.
5. Women leaders often excel in emotional intelligence and logical decision-making, making them effective in holistic and people-focused leadership roles.
6. Studies show that companies with gender-diverse leadership achieve better financial performance and have more satisfied workforces.
7. Women's different perspectives and problem-solving approaches enrich decision-making processes and enhance company culture.
8. Despite the evident benefits of female leadership, women remain underrepresented in executive positions due to deep-rooted gender biases.
9. Common misconceptions label women as too emotional or soft, while men are perceived as inherently stronger and more resilient leaders.
10. Women display resilience every day, balancing numerous roles and responsibilities, proving their strength and capability.
11. A shift towards gender-inclusive leadership is emerging, with organisations promoting gender diversity and working to bridge the leadership gap.
12. Real change requires cultural shifts, including unbiased hiring practices and mentorship programs that support women's growth in leadership.
13. Flexible work policies can help women balance personal and professional responsibilities, enhancing their career opportunities.
14. Celebrating women's unique leadership styles, rather than forcing them to adapt to masculine norms, can create more authentic leaders.
15. Recognising women's existing contributions and providing equal opportunities is crucial for organisational growth, empathy, and resilience.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



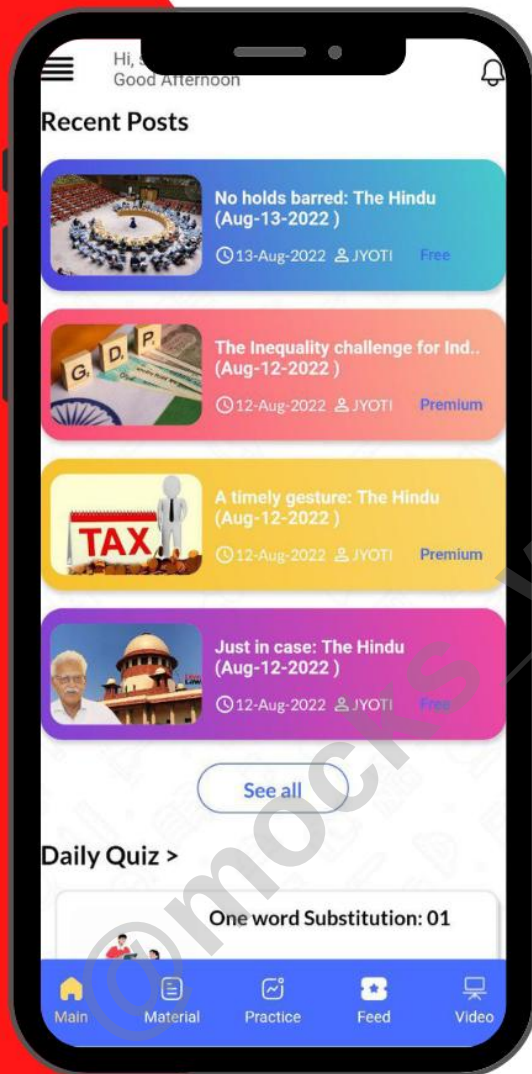
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